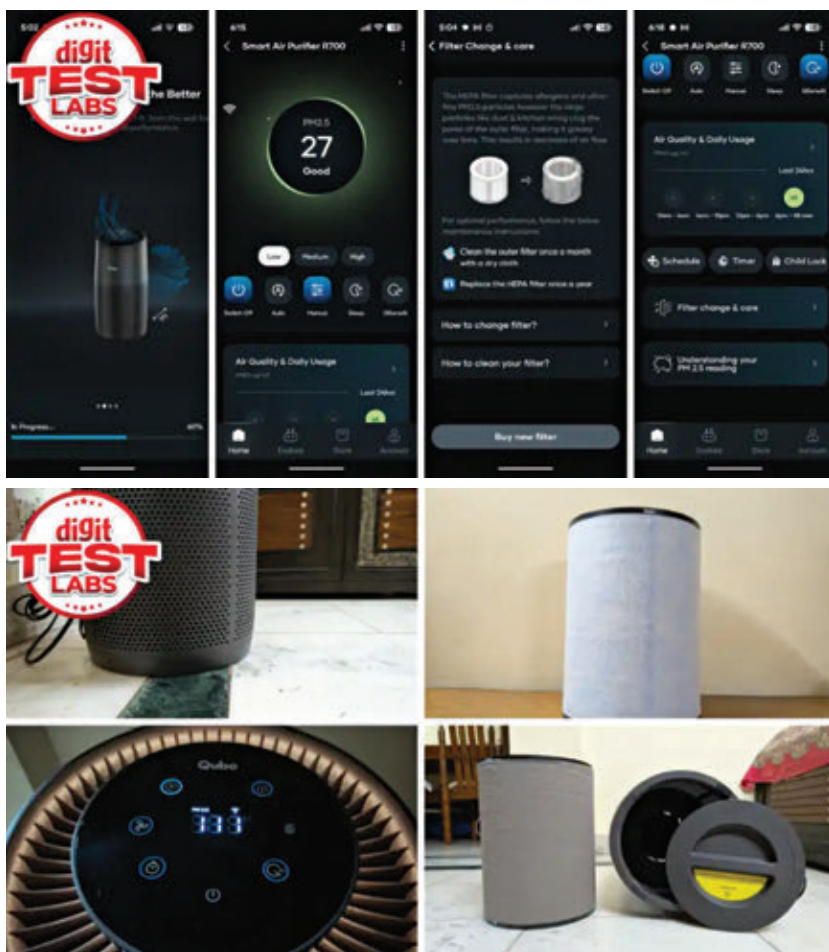




The Qubo R700 uses a 5-stage filtration setup consisting of:

- Pre-filter
- Anti-bacterial filter
- True HEPA H13 filter
- Activated carbon layer for odour, VOCs and cooking smells
- Nano-silver coating

The most important filter is True HEPA H13, which is rated to capture 99.95 to 99.99 per cent of particles measuring 0.3 microns. This includes: PM2.5 pollutants, fine dust, smoke particles, allergens, pollen, and Pet dander. We have a Labrador at our place, and he would quite often lie next to the purifier. Perhaps the cool air from it and the purifier don't get warm either. So, that's a thumbs up from his end, too.

Another aspect where I appreciate the Qubo R700 is its quiet operation. It is said to run up to 55 dB noise output.

So, at the highest fan speed, it is audible. But when it is running at moderate PM 2.5 levels, the fan noise isn't much. So, during afternoon nap, I didn't mind using it normally without sleep mode or putting it on standby. But if you prefer the least noise, sleep mode is quiet enough. The BLDR motor inside helps in this sound profile. There is no unnecessary rattling or vibration noises.

CONVENIENCE AND COSTS

So, the purifier supports Wi-Fi connectivity, the Qubo mobile app and within the app, you can enable the Amazon Alexa-based voice control feature. You can say commands like turn on the purifier, turn off the purifier, etc., and the connected R700 does so. But, I feel this is very fancy and in Indian homes, using the app controls or directly interacting with the device is more handy.

Besides remotely controlling the purifier, you can use the app to monitor air quality over a period of time, like 24 hours, 7 days, 30 days, a year, etc. You can use the app to schedule a timer, set a child lock and configure features like QSenseAI, enable silent mode, change the lighting brightness, or turn it off.

Qubo says the filter can last for 15,000 hours, and that's about a year and a half. This could differ based on your usage and pollution exposure in your place. On the Qubo website, the R700 filter costs Rs 4,250. That is not cheap for an Indian middle-class home, but the competition also charges in the range of Rs 3,000 to 5,000. This is as important a factor to consider as the upfront cost for long-term ownership.

VERDICT

The Qubo R700 gets most of the fundamentals right. It can automatically and timely detect pollutants and clean the air quickly. The coverage and air throw distance are good enough for bedrooms and even medium-to-large living rooms. It works quietly and has modes to ensure your sleep or focus isn't disturbed by its operation. The inclusion of a BLDC motor aids in its hushed performance and possibly power efficiency. All of these come packed in a functional design that is portable and should blend well into your room decor. This is backed by easily accessible LED-lit indicators and a serviceable app experience.

—G. S. Vasan

SPECIFICATIONS

Coverage area: 700 sq. ft | CADR: 460 m³/h | Power: 50W | Max Noise: 55 dB/A | Filters: 5 in 1, True HEPA 13 | Filter Life: Upto 15,000 Hrs | Motor: DC | Weight: 4.1 Kg

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